

Data Quality Report

Likitha Vankadoth · Data: DCCEEW Biodiversity Offsets Scheme registers, extracted 5 Oct 2026

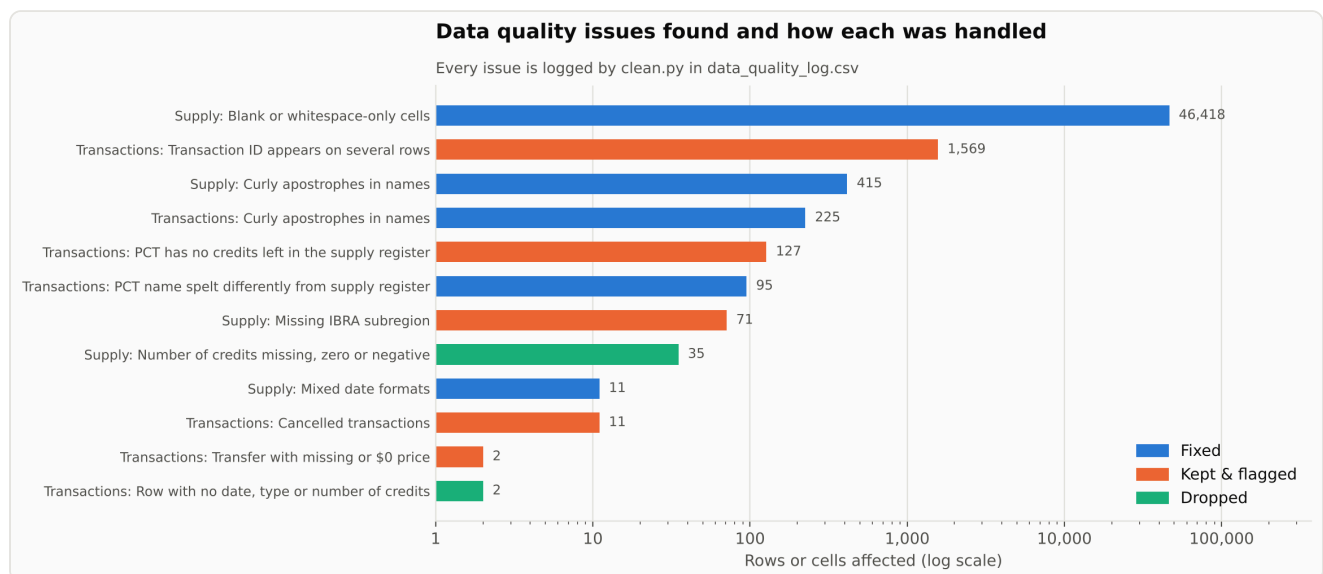
Source: DCCEEW Biodiversity Offsets Scheme public registers, extracted 5 October 2026.

Scripts: `src/readers.py` (file format), `src/clean.py` (cleaning and checks). Every check below is re-run automatically by `clean.py`, and the results are saved to `data/processed/data_quality_log.csv`.

1. Summary

Register	Raw rows	Clean rows	Rows dropped
Supply	2,861	2,826	35
Transactions	2,556	2,554	2
Demand	0	0	0

No rows were changed without being logged, and rows were only dropped when they could not be used at all.



2. File format issues

Issue	Detail	How it was handled
Mislabelled files	All three downloads end in <code>.xls</code> but are not Excel files. Supply and Demand are Excel 2003 XML (SpreadsheetML), and Transactions is an HTML page. Standard Excel readers fail.	Custom readers in <code>src/readers.py</code>

Issue	Detail	How it was handled
Title and disclaimer rows	5 rows of title and legal text sit above the real header row	The header row is found by its first column name
Broken XML	Unescaped & characters make the XML invalid	Parsed with a recovering XML parser
Skipped cells	Empty cells are omitted, and the next cell carries an <code>ss:Index</code> position	Empty cells are re-inserted so values stay in the correct column
Formula IDs	Transaction IDs are stored as Excel formulas, e.g. <code>"00018450"</code>	Formula wrapper removed and leading zeros kept
Two sheets	The supply file also has a summary sheet	Only the first (full) sheet is read

3. Data issues

Register	Check	Rows	Action
Demand	Register has no listings	—	Credit retirements used as the demand measure
Supply	Personal contact columns (9)	all	Removed for privacy
Transactions	Personal contact column (street address of obligation)	all	Removed for privacy
Supply	Blank or whitespace-only cells (e.g. dates stored as newlines)	46,418 cells	Set to missing
Supply	Curly apostrophes (') in names	415	Replaced with a straight apostrophe
Transactions	Curly apostrophes (') in names	225	Replaced with a straight apostrophe
Supply	Mixed date formats (YYYY-MM-DD alongside Month D, YYYY)	11	Converted to one format
Supply	Duplicate Credit ID	0	Checked, none found
Supply	Number of credits missing (all Expressions of Interest)	35	Dropped, since potential supply without numbers cannot be counted
Supply	Missing IBRA subregion (all BioBanking equivalence species credits)	71	Kept; expected, because species credits are matched by species, not region
Transactions	Row with no date, type or number of credits	2	Dropped
Transactions	Exact duplicate rows	0	Checked, none found
Transactions	Transaction ID on several rows	1,569	Kept; one transaction can cover several credit types
Transactions	Transfer with \$0 price	2	Kept, excluded from price analysis
Transactions	Cancelled transactions	11	Kept, excluded from demand

Register	Check	Rows	Action
Transactions	PCT name spelt differently from supply register	95	Fixed by matching on a simplified name
Transactions	PCT with no credits left in supply register	127	Kept, counted as zero supply

4. Notable findings

- **Inconsistent spelling across registers.** The supply register drops apostrophes ("Blakelys Red Gum") while the transactions register keeps them ("Blakely's Red Gum"). Exact matching would have wrongly treated 95 transactions as having no supply.
- **The demand register was empty** at extraction. Listing on it is voluntary except when proponents seek to use the variation rules, so it was never a complete picture of demand.
- **No PCT ID in transactions.** The transactions register gives only the PCT name, so the ID is looked up from the supply register.
- **Character encoding.** A few offset trading group names show `?` in place of a dash in the source data. These were left as published.

5. Remaining limitations

See the Limitations section of the [README](#).

Register data © State of New South Wales (DCCEEW), CC BY 4.0. Code and analysis: github.com/Likithaa07/nsw-biodiversity-credit-gap